

Slide 1

Psychology and Human Behavior

Week 7 Monday — The person and the situation

NRES 315: Human Dimensions of Fish and Wildlife Management

Last updated: 2026-10-05

1 / 10

Slide 2

"They just need to care more"

You will hear this sentence in a management meeting. It is almost always wrong — not because caring is irrelevant, but because the people in question usually already care.

This week asks what else has to be true before a person acts.

Source: Chapter 6, §6.2

2 / 10

Slide 3

Today's question

What does psychology add once we already know that people support a conservation goal?

Source: Chapter 6, §6.2

3 / 10

Slide 4

What you should be able to do

By the end of today, you should be able to:

- distinguish **cognition**, **conation**, and **affect**;
- explain the **person** and the **situation** as two interacting lenses;
- explain the **cognitive hierarchy** from values to specific behavior; and
- state the **specificity principle** and why it matters for prediction.

Source: Chapter 8, §§3-8.4.1

4 / 10

Slide 5

What psychology is for

It connects individual thought and behavior to practical management problems.

Source: Chapter 8, §8.2

5 / 10

Slide 6

Five jobs psychology does in management

- **Designing interventions** – targeting the actual drivers of action.
- **Enhancing participation** – uncovering what motivates or discourages different publics.
- **Managing conflict** – understanding the roots of conflict among people, groups, and institutions.
- **Contextual planning** – making plans relevant to local communities.
- **Informing decisions** – cognitive biases, emotions, bounded rationality, and uncertainty.

Source: Chapter 8, §8.2

6 / 10

Slide 7

A caution before we start

Most classic disciplines, psychology included, emerged within Western cultures and ways of knowing. There is often an implicit assumption that those concepts apply universally.

Cultural relevance: the degree to which a practice, intervention, or program is tailored to the specific cultural backgrounds, values, and experiences of a community.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.2.1

7 / 19

Slide 8

Three components of mental life

Cognition · conation · affect

Thinking, motivation, and emotion shape how we understand and respond to the world.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.3

8 / 19

Slide 9

Cognition, conation, affect

Motivational and volitional drive: will, intent, striving

Component	What it is	A question that reveals it
Cognition	Mental processes: perception, reasoning, memory	"Do you think draining your boat makes a difference?"
Conation	Motivational and volitional drive: will, intent, striving	"Do you intend to do it on your next trip?"
Affect	The experience of emotions and feelings	"How do you feel when you see the agency's sign?"

These interact to form internal states – beliefs and attitudes – which then appear as observable decisions and actions.

Source: Chapter 8, 98.3

9 / 19

Slide 10

The person and the situation

The person Intrapersonal factors. Internal explanations for thought and behavior.	The situation Interpersonal and situational factors. The social or biophysical structures that explain thought and behavior.
--	---

The person and the situation are **inseparable**. Social and cognitive psychology explain behavior by analyzing how the two interact.

Source: Chapter 6, 96.3

10 / 10

Slide 11

A worked contrast

A landowner **wants** to secure bear attractants but has nowhere secure to store them.

Diagnosing this as a values problem produces a brochure.

Diagnosing it as a situational constraint produces storage.

The same observed behavior — attractants left out — supports two completely different interventions. Only one of them can work.

Source: Chapter 6, 96.3

11 / 10

Slide 12

The cognitive hierarchy

How broad beliefs and values connect to specific attitudes and behaviors

From abstract and stable to specific and situational.

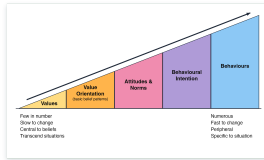
Source: Chapter 6, 96.4.1 and Box 6.5

12 / 10

Slide 13

From values to behavior

- **Values** are few, abstract, and stable across a life.
- **Value orientations** are patterns among basic beliefs – the link between abstract values and specific cognitions.
- **Attitudes and norms** are specific to an object or an action.
- **Intention** is the most immediate predictor of behavior.



Source: Chapter 8, 8E.4.1, Figure 8.1, and Box 8.3

13 / 19

Slide 14

Wildlife value orientations in the U.S.

Domination: wildlife should be managed for human benefit.

Mutualism: wildlife are part of our social community and deserve care.

Two orientations, four types:

- **Traditionalists:** high domination, low mutualism.
- **Mutualists:** high mutualism, low domination.
- **Pluralists:** high on both.
- **Distanced:** low on both.

Percent Mutualists by state, 2018



Nebraska: 29% • California: 48% • Wyoming: 22%
National survey: 43,949 respondents across all 50 states.

Source: CSU, America's Wildlife Values national report 2018 data, pp 13–15, Map 2, Text and Methods (2020)

14 / 19

Slide 15

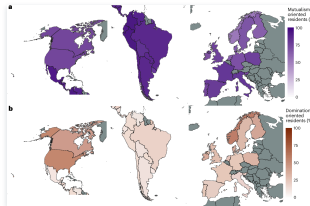
Wildlife values across Europe and the Americas

33 countries • 18,477 respondents • 2021–2023

Mutualism was more prevalent in Iberian-origin Latin America; domination was more prevalent in British-origin North America.

Read the panels separately: a person can score high on both orientations.

Gray areas were not surveyed.



Source: Marshido, Teal, and colleagues (2026), Nature Sustainability Figure 1

15 / 19

Slide 16

The specificity principle

Correlations between variables are larger when the variables **correspond** in target, action, context, and time.

An orientation describes broad beliefs about wildlife; a particular hunting decision is much more specific.

- Wildlife value orientations predict **general** acceptability of hunting well.
- They predict **archery hunting** [action] a **white-tailed deer** [target] in a **suburban neighborhood** [context] in **fall 2027** [time] far less well.

If you want to predict a specific behavior, you must measure something equally specific.

Source: Chapter 8, Box 8.5

16 / 19

Slide 17

Pair rehearsal: sort the evidence

With a partner, label each as **cognition, conation, or affect**:

1. "I don't think one person draining a boat matters."
2. "I feel blamed every time I read one of those signs."
3. "I plan to do it next time I'm out."
4. "Invasive mussels would ruin this lake."

Source: Chapter 8, 86.3

17 / 19

Slide 18

Wednesday and Friday

Wednesday: the frameworks — reasoned action and TACT, collective action and norms, emotions, motivation and satisfaction.

Before Friday: read the **Week 07 Case Brief: The Thornapple Lake Decontamination Problem**. It is a separate document in the Canvas module and is required preparation.

Source: Chapter 8, 884-843

18 / 19

